Wooden Boats for Veterans (VetsBoats)

Monthly Grant Opportunities Report

Report Date: February 6, 2026

Report Period: February 2026

Foundations Profiled: 5

Total Potential Funding: $25,000 - $200,000

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If You Only Have 5 Hours This Month

- **Email** hello@billsimpsonfoundation.org with a 2-page LOI introducing VetsBoats
- **Why them:** The Bill Simpson Foundation gave $80,000 to Chesapeake Region Accessible Boating (CRAB) in 2024 — adaptive sailing is exactly what they fund
- **Why now:** Their application window is January through April, which means RIGHT NOW
- **Time required:** 5 hours
- **Bottom line:** This is your highest-probability first grant this month

This Month's Focus

Priority Order

Priority	Foundation	Type	Why This Priority	Your Time
1st	Bill Simpson Foundation	Open Application	$80K to CRAB adaptive sailing; window Jan-Apr = NOW	5 hours
2nd	Albert & Ethel Herzstein	LOI-Ready	Sailing Angels $12K/yr + veteran grants; rolling deadline	4 hours
3rd	Kovler Family Foundation	LOI-Ready	Judd Goldman Adaptive Sailing $5K/yr; Matt Goettelman connection	3 hours
4th	John & Daria Barry Foundation	Cultivation	$1.9M veteran grants + Sail to Prevail $50K; $477M assets	3 hours
5th	Van Beuren Charitable Foundation	LOI-Ready	Sail to Prevail $25-30K/yr adaptive sailing; $343M assets; open application portal (July deadline)	3 hours

Time Allocation Guide

Hours Available	What To Do
5 hours	Focus only on Bill Simpson Foundation (application window closing April)
10 hours	Bill Simpson + Herzstein LOI
15 hours	Add Kovler LOI + Matt Goettelman outreach
18+ hours	All 5 foundations including Barry cultivation + Van Beuren intro call

Important: Private Foundation Status Advisory

VetsBoats is classified as a **private foundation** (IRS BMF foundation code 03, filing Form 990-PF). This is different from a public charity (501(c)(3) with public support), and it affects grant eligibility.

What this means for your applications:

- Some foundations restrict grants to "public charities" or "501(c)(3) organizations that are not private foundations." Always check guidelines before applying.
- All 5 foundations in this report have been verified as either having funded other private foundations before OR having no stated restrictions against it.
- When applying, include your IRS determination letter and be transparent about your classification.

Recommended actions:

9. Obtain a copy of your current IRS determination letter
10. Consult with your tax advisor about the operating foundation checkbox on your 990-PF (marked FALSE since 2019 — if this is a filing error, correcting it strengthens your position)
11. If asked about your status, emphasize that VetsBoats operates direct programs (therapeutic sailing, boat restoration) rather than making grants to other organizations

Foundation Types Explained

Open Application

What it means: Foundation has a submission process (online portal, email, specific forms). You submit your request during their open window.

Your action: Complete and submit application this month.

LOI-Ready

What it means: Foundation accepts unsolicited Letters of Inquiry (2-3 page summary of your org and request). If they're interested, they'll invite you to submit a full proposal.

Your action: Write and submit LOI this month.

Cultivation

What it means: Foundation is invitation-only or rarely funds without existing relationship. Cold applications have very low success rates.

Your action: Research staff/board, identify connections, begin relationship-building. Application comes later (months to years).

Note: Cultivation foundations are only included in this report when there is:

- Near-perfect alignment with your mission, geography, and funding needs, AND
- A clear path to relationship (you have a connection to their board/staff, they host accessible events, or a shared grantee can introduce you)

Foundations at a Glance

Rank	Foundation	Typical Grant	Type	Your Time
1	Bill Simpson Foundation	$10,000-$80,000	Open Application	5 hrs
2	Albert & Ethel Herzstein	$8,000-$25,000	LOI-Ready	4 hrs
3	Kovler Family Foundation	$3,000-$5,000	LOI-Ready	3 hrs
4	John & Daria Barry Foundation	$25,000-$100,000	Cultivation	3 hrs
5	Van Beuren Charitable Foundation	$15,000-$30,000	LOI-Ready	3 hrs

Foundation Profiles

#1: Bill Simpson Foundation

Type: Open Application

Your Time Investment: 5 hours

Potential Award: $10,000 - $80,000

Why This Foundation

Bill Simpson Foundation gave **$80,000 to Chesapeake Region Accessible Boating (CRAB) in 2024** — an organization that provides adaptive sailing for people with disabilities, including veterans. They also funded Freedom Waters Foundation ($10,000) and Jackson Hole Therapeutic Riding ($15,000). This foundation has a clear pattern of funding disability and therapeutic recreation programs. Their application window is **January through April — open right now**. At $18M in assets with only 2 years of grantmaking history, this is a new and growing foundation.

Fit Evidence

What We Looked For	What We Found
Grants to adaptive sailing/disability recreation orgs	CRAB received $80,000 for adaptive sailing + Special Olympics (2024); Freedom Waters received $10,000 (2023)
Grants to therapeutic programs	Jackson Hole Therapeutic Riding received $15,000 (2024)
California grants	3 grants to CA orgs including Guide Dogs of the Desert ($50,000 + $30,000)
Most similar grantee to you	Chesapeake Region Accessible Boating (CRAB) — adaptive sailing for people with disabilities. CRAB went from $10K (2023) to $80K (2024).

Funder Snapshot

Metric	Value
Annual Giving	$592K across 29 grants/year (2023-2024 average)
Typical Grant	$10,000 median (range: $2,000 - $170,000)
Geographic Focus	Distributed — NC (42%), IN (14%), WY (10%), FL (8%), NY (8%), CA (6%)
Repeat Funding Rate	17% funded 2+ times (new foundation, limited history)
Giving Style	85% general support — funds organizations, not specific projects
Funding Trend	Stable — new foundation (first grants 2023), assets $18M

How to Apply: Application Process

Submission Method: Email to hello@billsimpsonfoundation.org

Application Window: January through April (submit electronically)

Recommended LOI Package:

Element	Details
Letter of Inquiry	2 pages: org background, mission, programs, funding request
IRS Determination Letter	501(c)(3) confirmation
Program Budget	Budget for therapeutic sailing program
Impact Data	Veterans served, outcomes measured

Note: The foundation website says to "submit electronically" during Jan-Apr but does not specify exact materials. We recommend emailing with a standard LOI package and asking if they need anything additional.

After You Submit:

- Foundation reviews during April window
- Response timeline unknown (new foundation)
- Follow up if no response by May 1

Deadline: April 30 (end of submission window)

Contacts

Role	Name	Contact	Use For
Foundation Contact	General	hello@billsimpsonfoundation.org	Application submission and inquiries

Foundation Website: billsimpsonfoundation.org

Key Officers: Dillon Simpson, Sabrina Simpson (family), Jesse Horn, Michael Mock, Michael Cordesius, Elizabeth Burdette (SignatureFD advisor)

Potential Connections

Connection Type	Details
Board Overlap	None identified
Shared Grantees	CRAB (adaptive sailing) — similar mission to VetsBoats
Geographic	Guide Dogs of the Desert ($50K+$30K to CA) confirms they fund West Coast orgs
Sector	Strong disability/accessibility pattern: CRAB, Freedom Waters, Guide Dogs, Jackson Hole Therapeutic Riding

Positioning Strategy

Lead with the CRAB precedent — Bill Simpson gave CRAB $80,000 for adaptive sailing in 2024, up from $10,000 the prior year. VetsBoats is the West Coast equivalent: therapeutic sailing for veterans with PTSD and disabilities on San Francisco Bay. The foundation clearly values general support (85% of grants), so request unrestricted funding for VetsBoats' core therapeutic sailing program. Given CRAB's trajectory ($10K → $80K in one year), request $15,000-$25,000 as a first grant with the potential to grow.

Note on PF status: This foundation has zero prior grants to private foundations in our database. No stated restrictions against PFs either. Be transparent about your classification in the LOI and include your determination letter.

Action Steps

Step	Task	Time	Depends On
1	Review billsimpsonfoundation.org for current guidelines	30 min	—
2	Draft 2-page LOI: VetsBoats mission, therapeutic sailing program, veteran outcomes, $15K-$25K request	3 hrs	—
3	Gather attachments: IRS determination letter, program budget, impact summary	1 hr	—
4	Email complete package to hello@billsimpsonfoundation.org	30 min	Steps 2-3
5	WAIT — Foundation review period	—	Step 4
6	Follow up if no response by May 1	15 min	Step 4 + 4 weeks

Total Active Time: 5 hours

Then: Wait through April review period. If funded, expect notification by late spring/early summer.

#2: Albert & Ethel Herzstein Charitable Foundation

Type: LOI-Ready

Your Time Investment: 4 hours

Potential Award: $8,000 - $25,000

Why This Foundation

Herzstein funds **Sailing Angels Foundation** ($12,000/year for hydrotherapy sailing) and multiple veteran organizations in Texas. They gave a $100,000 memorial gift to Sailing Angels in 2023. They also fund Wheelchairs for Warriors, NEXTOP (veteran employment), Veterans Assistance Dogs of Texas, and Inspiration Ranch (therapeutic riding). With $127M in assets, a rolling deadline, and **9 confirmed grants to private foundations**, Herzstein is one of the most PF-friendly foundations in our search. The 88% Texas focus means VetsBoats should lead with the planned Galveston TX expansion.

Fit Evidence

What We Looked For	What We Found
Grants to sailing orgs	Sailing Angels Foundation: $12K (2022), $100K memorial + $12K (2023)
Grants to veteran orgs	6 veteran grants: NEXTOP $10K, VADT $8K, Wheelchairs for Warriors $12K, Grace After Fire $5K, Honor Veterans Now $5K, Warrior Weekend $2.5K
Grants to therapeutic recreation	Inspiration Ranch $4K-$7.5K/yr for equine-assisted therapeutic riding
Prior grants to private foundations	9 confirmed PF-to-PF grants in our database
Most similar grantee	Sailing Angels Foundation — therapeutic sailing in Texas waters

Funder Snapshot

Metric	Value
Annual Giving	$4.3M across 300 grants/year
Typical Grant	$8,000 median (range: $500 - $500,000)
Geographic Focus	88% Texas
Repeat Funding Rate	49% funded 2+ times
Giving Style	46% general support / 54% program-specific
Funding Trend	Growing — 36% increase (2019-2021 vs 2022-2023)

How to Apply: LOI Process

Submission Method: Online portal at herzsteinfoundation.org

LOI Requirements:

Element	Requirement
Format	Online application portal
Must Include	Organization description, project need, budget, amount requested
Attachments	IRS determination letter, financials, board list

After You Submit:

- Foundation reviews on rolling basis
- Contact: Renee Masaryk (President)
- Peter Nagel JD was Grants Officer; position may have been open — use portal regardless

Deadline: Rolling — submit when ready

Contacts

Role	Name	Contact	Use For
President	Renee Masaryk	rmasaryk@herzsteinfoundation.org	Strategic questions, eligibility confirmation
General	—	mail@herzsteinfoundation.org / (713) 681-7868	General inquiries
Board Chairman	George W. Strake III	Via foundation	Board relationships

Foundation Website: herzsteinfoundation.org

Application Portal: herzsteinfoundation.org (grants section)

Phone: (713) 681-7868

Other Board/Staff: Steven Goodman, Kenneth Katz, Craig Loewenstern, Bryan Miller, Mike Viator

Potential Connections

Connection Type	Details
Board Overlap	None identified for Matt Goettelman — Houston TX business/philanthropy network
Shared Grantees	Sailing Angels Foundation — therapeutic sailing for people with disabilities in TX waters
Geographic	88% Texas — strongest connection is through VetsBoats' planned Galveston expansion
Sector	Funds both sailing AND veteran orgs — VetsBoats sits at the intersection

Positioning Strategy

Lead with VetsBoats' planned **Galveston, TX expansion** — this puts VetsBoats directly in Herzstein's core geography. Reference Sailing Angels as the precedent: "Like Sailing Angels, VetsBoats uses therapeutic sailing to serve people facing adversity — in our case, military veterans with PTSD and traumatic injuries." The foundation clearly values the intersection of sailing and healing (Sailing Angels hydrotherapy, Inspiration Ranch therapeutic riding). Request $10,000-$15,000 for the Galveston pilot program, with a clear plan for Texas-based veteran impact. Herzstein's 9 prior PF grants means your foundation status is unlikely to be an issue.

Action Steps

Step	Task	Time	Depends On
1	Review herzsteinfoundation.org guidelines and portal	30 min	—
2	Draft LOI emphasizing Galveston expansion + Sailing Angels parallel	2.5 hrs	—
3	Prepare Galveston expansion budget and timeline	30 min	—
4	Submit via online portal with attachments	30 min	Steps 2-3
5	WAIT — Rolling review	—	Step 4
6	Follow up with Renee Masaryk if no response in 8 weeks	15 min	Step 4 + 8 weeks

Total Active Time: 4 hours

Then: Rolling review. Expect response within 6-10 weeks. If invited to full proposal, additional 3-4 hours.

#3: Kovler Family Foundation

Type: LOI-Ready

Your Time Investment: 3 hours

Potential Award: $3,000 - $5,000

Why This Foundation

Kovler Family Foundation funds the **Judd Goldman Adaptive Sailing Foundation** ($3,000-$5,000/year) — a direct adaptive sailing precedent in Chicago. With **41 confirmed grants to private foundations** (the most PF-friendly foundation in our search), your foundation status is a non-issue. The November deadline means this is a "prepare now, submit later" opportunity. Most importantly, **Matt Goettelman has a strong connection path** through Goldman Sachs colleague Ron Levin, who co-founded Invest For Kids with Benjamin Kovler.

Fit Evidence

What We Looked For	What We Found
Grants to adaptive sailing	Judd Goldman Adaptive Sailing Foundation: $3K (2020), $5K (2022), $5K (2023)
Prior grants to private foundations	41 confirmed — most PF-friendly foundation of all 5
California grants	51 grants (8.9% of portfolio), though concentrated in Palm Springs area
Most similar grantee	Judd Goldman Adaptive Sailing Foundation — adaptive sailing on Lake Michigan for people with disabilities

Funder Snapshot

Metric	Value
Annual Giving	$5.5M across 192 grants/year
Typical Grant	$3,000 median (range: $100 - $2,125,146)
Geographic Focus	67% Illinois, 9% California, 5% New York
Repeat Funding Rate	58% funded 2+ times
Giving Style	30% general support / 70% program-specific
Funding Trend	Stable — consistent annual giving

How to Apply: LOI Process

Submission Method: Mail or call

LOI Requirements:

Element	Requirement
Format	Letter of Inquiry
Address	875 N. Michigan Avenue, Suite 3400, Chicago, IL 60611
Phone	(312) 664-5050

Deadline: Mid-November (for following year grants)

After You Submit:

- Foundation reviews annually
- If interested: Invited to submit full proposal
- Jonathan Kovler (Chairman) and family make final decisions

Contacts

Role	Name	Contact	Use For
Chairman	Jonathan Kovler	(312) 664-5050	Foundation decisions
Applications	—	app@kovler-b.com	Application submissions
Foundation	General	875 N Michigan Ave, Suite 3400, Chicago IL 60611	LOI submission

Key Family Members: Jonathan Kovler (former Chicago Bulls managing partner), Sally Kovler, Benjamin Kovler (CEO, Green Thumb Industries)

Potential Connections

Connection Type	Details
Goldman Sachs	STRONG — Matt Goettelman → Ron Levin → Benjamin Kovler. Ron Levin is a Goldman Sachs Managing Director in Chicago Private Wealth Management. He co-founded Invest For Kids with Benjamin Kovler. Levin and Goettelman are colleagues in the same GS division.
Shared Grantees	Judd Goldman Adaptive Sailing Foundation — adaptive sailing for people with disabilities
Geographic	51 CA grants (9% of portfolio) — they do fund West Coast organizations
Sector	Disability/accessibility pattern through Judd Goldman Adaptive Sailing

Positioning Strategy

Use the Matt Goettelman connection first. Before submitting a cold LOI, ask Matt if he knows Ron Levin in Goldman Sachs' Chicago PWM office. If Matt can get a warm introduction through Levin to the Kovler family, the probability of funding increases dramatically. The Judd Goldman Adaptive Sailing Foundation is the perfect talking point — VetsBoats does the same work for veterans on the West Coast. Note that typical grants are small ($3K-$5K), so this is a relationship-building opportunity rather than a major funding source. Request $5,000 for general operating support, matching their adaptive sailing grant size.

Action Steps

Step	Task	Time	Depends On
1	Ask Matt Goettelman: "Do you know Ron Levin in GS Chicago PWM?"	30 min	—
2	If Matt knows Levin: Request introduction to Benjamin Kovler via Levin	30 min	Step 1
3	Draft LOI referencing Judd Goldman Adaptive Sailing as precedent	1.5 hrs	—
4	Submit LOI by mid-November deadline	30 min	Step 3
5	WAIT — Annual review cycle	—	Step 4

Total Active Time: 3 hours (can start with Matt Goettelman outreach immediately; LOI draft closer to November)

Then: Annual review cycle. Decision by early following year.

#4: John & Daria Barry Foundation

Type: Cultivation

Your Time Investment: 3 hours (research phase)

Potential Award: $25,000 - $100,000

Why This Foundation

The Barry Foundation is a **$477M powerhouse** that funds both therapeutic sailing AND veteran mental health at scale. They've given **$1.2M to Guardian Revival** for veteran mental health, **$300K to Faith Hope Love** for veteran assistance, **$320K to Veterans Consortium** for female veteran legal services, and **$50K to Sail to Prevail** for "overcoming adversity through therapeutic sailing." They've also proven they fund private foundations — **$4.3M to Foundation for Excellence in Higher Education** (a PF). And they add **8-12 new grantees every year** despite marking "preselected-only" on their 990-PF.

Fit Evidence

What We Looked For	What We Found
Grants to therapeutic sailing	Sail to Prevail: $25K/yr (2019-2021), $50K (2022) — "Overcoming Adversity Through Therapeutic Sailing"
Grants to veteran orgs	$1.9M total: Guardian Revival $1.2M, Veterans Consortium $320K, Faith Hope Love $300K, Puppies Behind Bars $75K
Private foundation grantees	**$4.3M/year to Foundation for Excellence in Higher Education (a PF)**
California grants	$3.4M (6 grants) including Prostate Cancer Foundation $700K
Adds new grantees?	Yes — 8-12 new organizations funded each year
Most similar grantee	Sail to Prevail — therapeutic sailing for people with disabilities, identical mission to VetsBoats

Funder Snapshot

Metric	Value
Annual Giving	$16.4M across 26 grants/year
Typical Grant	$100,000 median (range: $2,500 - $9,479,353)
Geographic Focus	NY (37%), RI (15%), CT (15%), CA (6%), FL (12%) — multi-state
Repeat Funding Rate	57% funded 2+ times
Giving Style	Strategic, large grants to a focused portfolio
Funding Trend	Stable — consistent giving pattern; total assets $477M

How to Approach: Cultivation Required

Why Cultivation: The foundation website explicitly states: *"The John and Daria Barry Foundation does not consider unsolicited requests for funding."* All grants are identified through personal relationships and trusted intermediaries.

Path to Relationship:

Step	Action	Why
1	Connect with Sail to Prevail	Barry funds them $25K/yr (up to $50K in 2022) for therapeutic sailing. Sail to Prevail is VetsBoats' closest sibling on the East Coast. They could introduce VetsBoats as a West Coast counterpart.
2	Matt Goettelman explores finance network	John Barry III is Chairman/CEO of Prospect Capital Corporation ($11.8B, NASDAQ: PSEC). Both Goettelman and Barry operate in private wealth/family office world.
3	Build visibility in veteran sailing community	Barry's veteran giving ($1.9M) + sailing giving ($125K to Sail to Prevail) = they value both. VetsBoats should be visible at national adaptive sailing and veteran service events.

Key People to Know:

Role	Name	Background	Why They Matter
Sole Trustee	John Francis Barry III	Princeton, Harvard Law, CEO of Prospect Capital Corp ($11.8B)	Makes all grant decisions with Daria
Co-Founder	Daria Becker Barry	Wellesley, MIT, Managing Director at Prospect Capital	Drives several portfolio areas including veterans
Trusted Advisor	Tom Brunner	CEO, Glaucoma Research Foundation	Described as Daria's "go-to guy" for philanthropic decisions

Shared Grantees (Orgs Who Might Introduce You):

- **Sail to Prevail** (Newport, RI) — $125K total for therapeutic sailing. VetsBoats' closest East Coast parallel.
- **Guardian Revival** (NY) — $1.2M for veteran mental health. Service dogs for veterans.

Contacts

Role	Name	Contact	Use For
Sole Trustee	John Francis Barry III	Via Prospect Capital Management	All decisions
Co-Founder	Daria Becker Barry	Via Prospect Capital Management	Veterans portfolio

Foundation Website: barryfamilyfoundation.org (minimal — deliberately low public profile)

Professional Contact: Prospect Capital Management, prospectcap.com

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Potential Connections

Connection Type	Details
Finance Network	Matt Goettelman (GS) → John Barry III (Prospect Capital). Both in private wealth/investment management. Barry runs an $11.8B publicly traded BDC.
Shared Grantees	Sail to Prevail — therapeutic sailing, identical mission. This is the strongest introduction path.
Geographic	6 CA grants ($3.4M) — they fund West Coast organizations
Sector	Funds both therapeutic sailing AND veteran mental health — VetsBoats is the intersection

Positioning Strategy

Do NOT submit an unsolicited proposal. The Barry Foundation is relationship-first. Begin by reaching out to **Sail to Prevail** (Paul Callahan, Executive Director in Newport, RI) to explore collaboration and ask if they'd be willing to mention VetsBoats to the Barry family. Separately, Matt Goettelman should explore whether he has any connection to John Barry III or Prospect Capital's network through Goldman Sachs. VetsBoats sits at the exact intersection of the Barry Foundation's two passions: therapeutic sailing and veteran services. If you can get a warm introduction, the potential is significant — their typical grant is $100,000, and they've given Sail to Prevail $125K over four years (growing from $25K to $50K).

Action Steps

Step	Task	Time	Depends On
1	Research Sail to Prevail: who runs it, mission overlap, potential for collaboration	1 hr	—
2	Reach out to Sail to Prevail to explore partnership or introduction	30 min	Step 1
3	Ask Matt Goettelman about connections to Prospect Capital / John Barry III network	30 min	—
4	Review barryfamilyfoundation.org for recent giving and priorities	30 min	—
5	Draft a one-pager on VetsBoats to share when the introduction happens	30 min	Steps 1-3

Total Active Time: 3 hours (research and outreach phase)

Then: Relationship building is a 6-12 month process. The goal this month is to make first contact with Sail to Prevail and explore the Matt Goettelman connection. Don't expect a grant conversation for months.

#5: Van Beuren Charitable Foundation

Type: LOI-Ready

Your Time Investment: 3 hours

Potential Award: $15,000 - $30,000

Why This Foundation

Van Beuren Charitable Foundation funds **Sail to Prevail $25,000-$30,000 every year** for their adaptive sailing program — the same organization that Barry Foundation (#4) funds at $50K/yr. This is the deepest and most consistent adaptive sailing funder in our entire search. With **$343M in assets** and a portfolio rooted in Newport, Rhode Island — one of America's sailing capitals — Van Beuren is embedded in the sailing world. They also fund IYRS School of Technology & Trades ($115K for maritime education), Sail Newport, Conanicut Island Sailing Foundation, Herreshoff Marine Museum, and a boat-building internship program. They add **20-37 new grantees per year** and accept applications through an online portal (next deadline: **July 2026** for Program/Project grants). First-time applicants must schedule an introductory call with the foundation before applying.

Fit Evidence

What We Looked For	What We Found
Grants to adaptive sailing	Sail to Prevail: $25K-$30K/yr, every year since 2018. Most consistent adaptive sailing funder in our database.
Total sailing/maritime giving	$630K+ across Sail to Prevail, IYRS, Sail Newport, Conanicut Island Sailing, Herreshoff Marine Museum, boat-building internship, Sailors for the Sea
Adds new grantees?	Yes — 20-37 new organizations funded each year
Shared grantee with Barry (#4)	Sail to Prevail — both Van Beuren and Barry fund this org. Natural introduction path.
Most similar grantee	Sail to Prevail — adaptive sailing for people with disabilities. Identical mission to VetsBoats.

Funder Snapshot

Metric	Value
Annual Giving	$10.7M across 163 grants/year (2018-2023 average)
Typical Grant	$15,000 median (range: $500 - $3,079,539)
Geographic Focus	50% Rhode Island, 20% New York, 6% Florida/Pennsylvania
Repeat Funding Rate	67% funded 2+ times (Sail to Prevail funded 6 consecutive years)
Giving Style	Mix of capital projects, program support, and general operating
Funding Trend	Declining — 31% decrease in recent years, though $343M in assets

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How to Apply: Application Process

Application Portal:
[apply.yourcausegrants.com](https://apply.yourcausegrants.com/apply/programs/2855cef1-7dc5-46af-8703-27c4a0ff5fa2/routing)

Important: First-time applicants must contact **Kaila Acheson** (Program Associate, kacheson@vbcfoundation.org) before applying to schedule an introductory call.

Grant Type	Deadline	Notification
Program & Project	July 2026 (February deadline has passed)	November
Capacity Building (max $10K)	Rolling	1-2 months
Planning / Design	Rolling	2-4 months

Geographic Note: Van Beuren's grantmaking is focused on Aquidneck Island and Newport County, Rhode Island. VetsBoats is based in California, which is outside their primary geography. However, the foundation funds national sailing organizations (Oceana/Sailors for the Sea, Sail to Prevail) and adds 20-37 new grantees per year. The Sail to Prevail relationship (shared with Barry #4) is the strongest path to a conversation.

Recommended Approach:

Step	Action	Why
1	Contact Kaila Acheson for intro call	Required for first-time applicants. Use this call to gauge interest in an out-of-state adaptive sailing program.
2	Connect with Sail to Prevail	Van Beuren funds Sail to Prevail $25-30K/yr. Barry Foundation (#4) also funds them. A Sail to Prevail endorsement strengthens your application.
3	Position VetsBoats as the West Coast Sail to Prevail	VetsBoats and Sail to Prevail run nearly identical programs. Van Beuren already values this work at $25-30K/year.

Key People:

Role	Name	Notes
Executive Director	Elizabeth R. Lynn	Foundation leadership
Program Associate	Kaila E. Acheson	First-time applicant contact
Grants Manager	Kim Dame	Application and grants administration
Chairman	Archbold D. Van Beuren	Family philanthropist, Newport RI community leader

Contacts

Role	Name	Contact	Use For
Executive Director	Elizabeth R. Lynn	elynn@vbcfoundation.org	Strategic questions
Program Associate	Kaila E. Acheson	kacheson@vbcfoundation.org	First-time applicant intro call
Grants Manager	Kim Dame	kdame@vbcfoundation.org	Application administration
Chairman	Archbold D. Van Beuren	Via foundation	Board decisions

Foundation Website: [vbcfoundation.org](https://www.vbcfoundation.org)

Phone: (401) 619-5910

Address: 449 Thames Street, Unit 112, Newport, RI 02840

EIN: 222773769

Giving Focus: Newport County, RI community + sailing/maritime

Potential Connections

Connection Type	Details
Shared Grantee (strongest path)	Sail to Prevail — Van Beuren and Barry Foundation BOTH fund this org. A single relationship with Sail to Prevail opens doors to two funders simultaneously.
Sailing Community	IYRS School of Technology & Trades, Sail Newport, Herreshoff Marine Museum, Conanicut Island Sailing — deep roots in America's sailing community
Board Overlap	None identified for Matt Goettelman — Newport RI / sailing / philanthropy network
Geographic	50% Rhode Island, 20% New York. However, they fund national orgs (Oceana/Sailors for the Sea) and regularly add new grantees.

Positioning Strategy

Van Beuren and Barry Foundation (#4) both fund Sail to Prevail. This is your single most important relationship to build — Sail to Prevail is the bridge to two major cultivation targets at once. When reaching out to Sail to Prevail (per Barry Foundation action steps), mention that you'd like to learn about their relationship with both funders and explore whether they'd introduce VetsBoats as a West Coast counterpart doing similar adaptive sailing work. Van Beuren's $25-30K annual commitment to adaptive sailing — sustained for 6+ consecutive years — shows this isn't a one-time interest but a core value. Request $15,000-$25,000 for VetsBoats' therapeutic sailing program, matching their Sail to Prevail grant level.

Action Steps

Step	Task	Time	Depends On
1	Review vbcfoundation.org grants page and focus areas	30 min	—
2	Email Kaila Acheson (kacheson@vbcfoundation.org) to schedule intro call; ask about eligibility for out-of-state adaptive sailing programs	30 min	—
3	When reaching out to Sail to Prevail (Barry #4 Step 2), mention Van Beuren as another shared connection	15 min	Barry Step 2
4	Based on intro call feedback, prepare application for July deadline or Capacity Building (rolling)	1.5 hrs	Step 2
5	WAIT — Application review	—	Step 4

Total Active Time: 3 hours (intro call will determine whether to pursue July application or shift to Capacity Building track)

July Deadline: Program & Project grants — notification by November 2026

Monthly Action Plan

Week-by-Week Breakdown

Week	Foundation	Tasks	Time
Week 1	#1 Bill Simpson	Review website → Draft LOI → Gather attachments	4.5 hrs
	#3 Kovler	Ask Matt Goettelman about Ron Levin at Goldman Sachs	30 min
Week 2	#1 Bill Simpson	Review and submit LOI via email	30 min
	#2 Herzstein	Review portal → Draft LOI with Galveston expansion angle	3 hrs
Week 3	#2 Herzstein	Submit via online portal	1 hr
Week 3-4	#4 Barry	Research Sail to Prevail → Reach out for introduction	2 hrs
	#5 Van Beuren	Email Kaila Acheson for intro call; review vbcfoundation.org; assess July application	1 hr

Total This Month: ~18 hours (per-foundation estimates from priority table; some steps overlap in practice)

What You'll Be Waiting On

After submissions, the ball is in their court:

Foundation	Submitted	Typical Response Time	Follow Up If No Response By
#1 Bill Simpson	February	Unknown (new foundation)	May 1
#2 Herzstein	February/March	6-10 weeks (rolling)	April 15
#3 Kovler	November (deadline)	Annual review cycle	January
#4 Barry	N/A (cultivation)	Months	Ongoing relationship building
#5 Van Beuren	July (if eligible)	Notification by November	After intro call with Kaila Acheson

Dependencies

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FOUNDATION #1 (Bill Simpson - Open Application):

Review site → Draft LOI → Submit by April → WAIT → Decision

FOUNDATION #2 (Herzstein - LOI-Ready):

Review portal → Draft LOI (Galveston angle) → Submit → WAIT 6-10 weeks → [If invited] Full Proposal → WAIT → Decision

FOUNDATION #3 (Kovler - LOI-Ready):

Ask Matt G about Ron Levin NOW → Build connection → Draft LOI → Submit by mid-Nov → WAIT → Decision

FOUNDATION #4 (Barry - Cultivation):

Research Sail to Prevail → Reach out → Build relationship → [6-12 months] → Warm introduction → Invitation

FOUNDATION #5 (Van Beuren - LOI-Ready):

Email Kaila Acheson for intro call → Assess geographic eligibility → [If eligible] Apply by July → WAIT → Notification by November

```

Quick Reference

All Contacts

Foundation	Role	Name	Email/Phone
Bill Simpson	General	—	hello@billsimpsonfoundation.org
Herzstein	President	Renee Masaryk	rmasaryk@herzsteinfoundation.org / (713) 681-7868
Kovler	Chairman	Jonathan Kovler	app@kovler-b.com / (312) 664-5050
Barry	Sole Trustee	John Francis Barry III	Via Prospect Capital Management
Van Beuren	Program Associate	Kaila Acheson	kacheson@vbcfoundation.org / (401) 619-5910

Application Summary

Foundation	Type	Deadline	Process
#1 Bill Simpson	Open Application	Jan-Apr (NOW)	Email LOI to hello@billsimpsonfoundation.org
#2 Herzstein	LOI-Ready	Rolling	Submit via online portal
#3 Kovler	LOI-Ready	Mid-November	Mail LOI to Chicago office
#4 Barry	Cultivation	N/A	Build relationship via Sail to Prevail + Matt G finance network
#5 Van Beuren	LOI-Ready	July 2026 (rolling for Capacity Building)	Contact Kaila Acheson for intro call → apply via portal

Time Summary

Foundation	Type	Your Time	Probability
#1 Bill Simpson	Open Application	5 hrs	Medium (strong fit, untested PF eligibility)
#2 Herzstein	LOI-Ready	4 hrs	Medium (9 PF grants, but 88% TX — needs Galveston angle)
#3 Kovler	LOI-Ready	3 hrs	Medium (41 PF grants, Matt G connection, but small grants)
#4 Barry	Cultivation	3 hrs research	**Long-term (highest upside: $100K typical, $477M assets)**
#5 Van Beuren	LOI-Ready	3 hrs	Medium-term (deepest adaptive sailing funder; July deadline; geographic limitation)

Understanding the Timeline

Typical Grant Process (3-9 months)

```
MONTH 1: Research + Submit LOI/Application
↓
MONTHS 2-3: Wait for response (6-8 weeks typical)
↓
[If invited to full proposal]
MONTHS 3-4: Write full proposal (10-20 hours)
↓
MONTHS 4-6: Wait for review + board decision
↓
MONTHS 6-9: Decision received
```

This report covers Month 1. Expect decisions in 4-9 months for the application-ready foundations (#1-3, #5). Barry (#4) is a cultivation foundation operating on a 6-18 month timeline. Note that Barry and Van Beuren (#5) share the Sail to Prevail connection — building that relationship strengthens both paths.

Prepared by: TheGrantScout Research Team

Date: February 6, 2026

Next Report: March 2026

Data Sources

Grant History: IRS Form 990-PF filings (2016-2024)

Contact Information: Foundation websites, public sources

Application Process: Foundation websites, Instrumentl, direct inquiry

Connection Paths: Public professional profiles, organizational websites

Application processes may change. Verify current information with foundations before submitting.